

PREPARED FOR EUGEN

5-Channel Social Media Automation

PHASE 1A

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VERSION
1.0

THE SITUATION

Right now you have two workflows that each do their job — HeyGen generates your avatar videos, and Blotato handles the actual posting. The problem is neither one knows the other exists. There's no shared brain between them, so someone still has to manually wire the output of one into the input of the other every single time. That's not automation. That's task delegation with extra steps. Phase 1A puts a Google Sheets CMS between the two — a single layer that both workflows read from and write back to. Once that's in place, the machine runs itself.

WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

GOOGLE SHEETS CMS – THE ORCHESTRATION LAYER

Sheets becomes the single source of truth. Every row is a piece of content. Workflows read from it, post, then write the result back. Nothing fires without a row saying it's ready. The queue logic prevents duplicates: the first thing any workflow does when it picks up a row is lock it — so two instances running simultaneously can't collide.

COLUMN	WHAT IT DOES
topic	What the post covers
content_type	Reel, photo, or carousel
platform	TikTok, LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram
status	ready → locked → posting → done / failed
scheduled_time	When to post
drive_file_id	Where the generated media lives in Drive
post_id	Platform's confirmation ID after a successful post
attempt_count	Retry counter (max 3 before flagging as failed)
error_log	Last error message if the row fails

WORKFLOW ADAPTATIONS

The HeyGen workflow gets its input source swapped — instead of reading from wherever it currently reads, it reads the next ready reel row from Sheets, generates the video, saves it to Google Drive, and writes the file ID back to that row. The Blotato posting nodes stay. Only the input changes: Blotato gets replaced with a direct Sheets read. The channel nodes for TikTok, LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram are kept as-is.

CHANNELS IN THIS PHASE

CHANNEL	CONTENT TYPE	STATUS
TikTok	Avatar reels	Included
LinkedIn	Photos + carousels	Included
Facebook	Reels + photos + carousels	Included
Instagram	Reels + photos + carousels	Included
YouTube	Shorts	Phase 1B

MILESTONE BREAKDOWN

WEEK 1 Sheets Schema + HeyGen

- Google Sheets CMS built out — Content Queue, Settings, and Logs tabs
- HeyGen workflow updated to read from Sheets
- Generated videos save to Google Drive automatically
- Row status updates correctly after each generation

Checkpoint — HeyGen generates an avatar video from a Sheets row with no manual input

WEEK 2 All Publishers Live

- Blotato channel nodes wired to Sheets queue as input source
- Row lock pattern active — no duplicate posts possible
- Daily rate limit counters running per platform
- All 4 channels posting successfully from the queue on a manual trigger

Checkpoint — One full cycle completes: row enters queue, video generates, posts to all 4 channels, row updates to done

WEEK 3 Stability + Handoff

- End-to-end automated run — no manual trigger required
- Failed rows clearly marked in Sheets with error details
- Cross-platform testing across all content types
- Handoff documentation: Sheets schema, workflow logic, how to add new content rows

Checkpoint — System completes a full automated cycle, posts correctly to all 4 channels, no manual input required

WHAT'S DEFERRED

FEATURE	REASON FOR DEFERRAL
Content generator (News API + GPT-4 + Flux/DALL-E)	Phase 1A uses manual Sheets input — you write topics directly
Advanced retry with exponential backoff	Basic failure logging only; manual fix on failed rows
Telegram monitoring and daily summary	Phase 1B
YouTube Shorts	Same architecture, added when Phase 1A is stable
Carousel automation counter	Carousels added manually to the queue for v1
Content approval / review mode toggle	Phase 2 feature

Without the content generator, you write topics into Sheets manually for Phase 1A. That means the '5 minutes per day' target isn't fully there yet — closer to 15-20 minutes. Phase 1B eliminates that entirely. This trade-off is intentional: prove the publishing layer works first, then automate the content input layer.

Start on n8n cloud (\$20/month). It handles Docker, SSL, and backups so those don't eat into build time. Once Phase 1A is stable, migrating to a self-hosted VPS — Hetzner CX21 at €5/month — takes 30 minutes: export workflows as JSON, import on the new instance, done. If you already have a VPS set up, we can start there.

MONTHLY API COSTS (SEPARATE FROM BUILD FEE)

SERVICE	MONTHLY ESTIMATE
HeyGen (60 videos/month)	\$80 – \$120
DALL-E 3 (photos, Facebook + Instagram)	\$7
n8n cloud	\$20
Total operational cost	~\$107 – \$147/month

INVESTMENT

RECOMMENDED STARTING POINT

Phase 1A — 4 channels, 3 weeks

\$1,200 – \$1,500

Fixed number after reviewing your existing workflows

ADD-ON AFTER PHASE 1A IS STABLE

Phase 1B — content gen, retry, Telegram, YouTube

\$800 – \$1,000

FULL SYSTEM

Phase 1A + 1B combined

\$2,000 – \$2,500

The Phase 1A range depends on the condition of your existing workflows. Once I see them — either a JSON export from n8n or a quick Loom of the canvas — I'll give you a single fixed number, no range.

PAYMENT TERMS

50% upfront to begin · 50% on completion, once the automated cycle runs clean across all 4 channels. No milestone splits on a 3-week build — simpler for both sides.

NEXT STEP

Export your existing workflows from n8n as JSON, or record a 2-minute Loom of the canvas. That's all I need to lock in the fixed price and confirm the start date. If a 20-minute call is faster, I can work around your schedule this week.